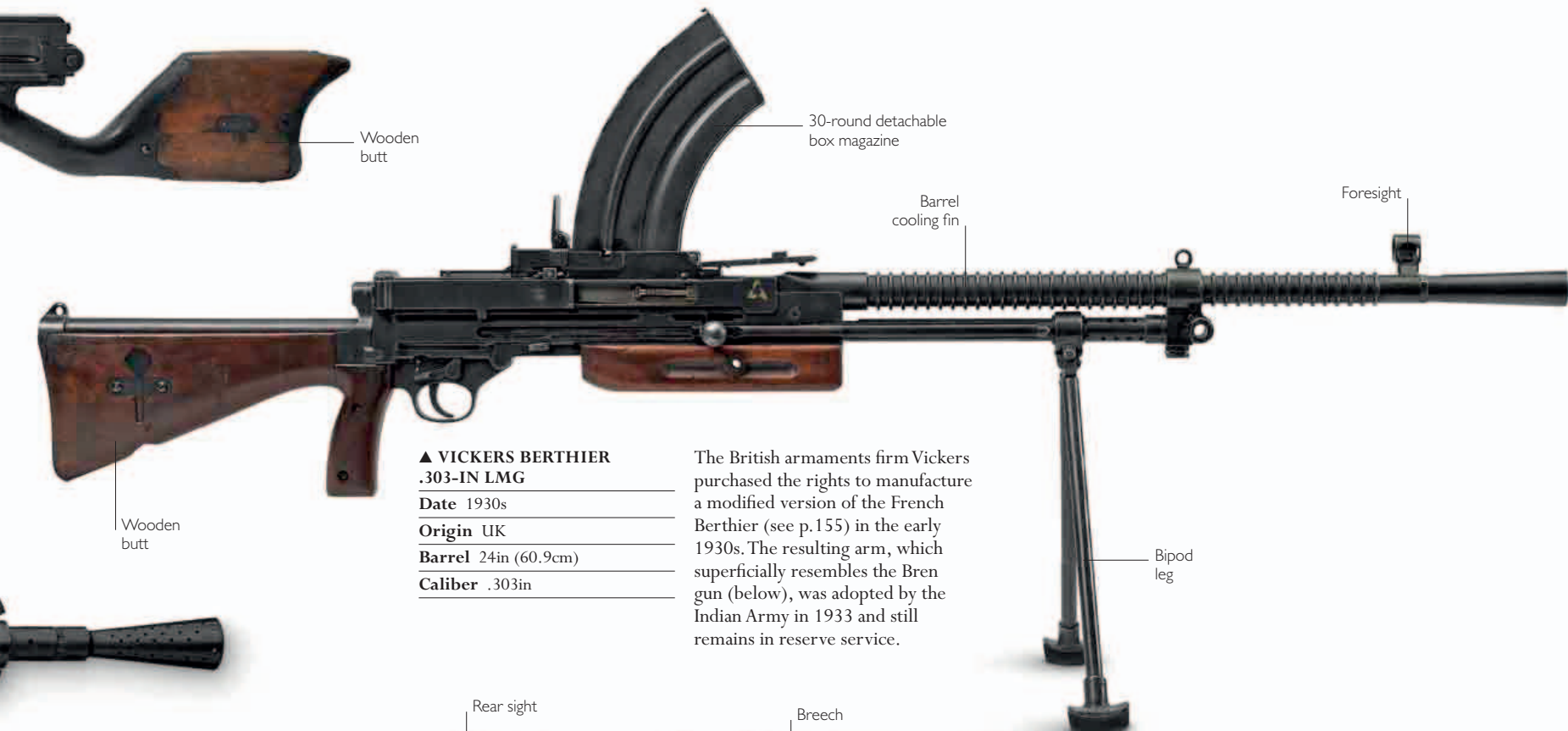




▲ VICKERS BERTHIER
.303-IN LMG

Date 1930s

Origin UK

Barrel 24in (60.9cm)

Caliber .303in

The British armaments firm Vickers purchased the rights to manufacture a modified version of the French Berthier (see p.155) in the early 1930s. The resulting arm, which superficially resembles the Bren gun (below), was adopted by the Indian Army in 1933 and still remains in reserve service.



▲ BREDA MODELLO 30

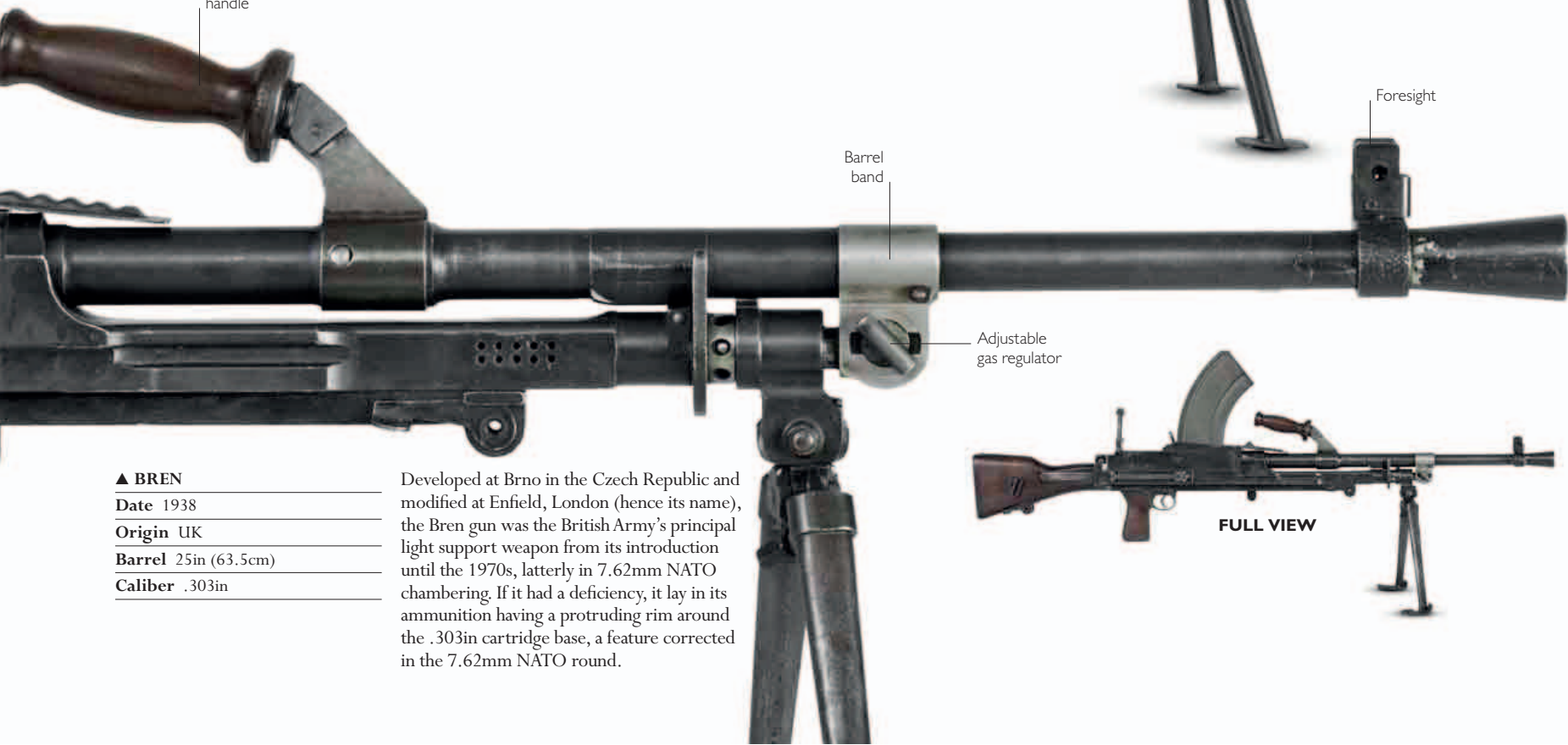
Date 1930

Origin Italy

Barrel 20½in (52cm)

Caliber 6.5 × 54mm

The standard light machine-gun of the Italian Army, the Breda Modello 30 utilized a novel 20-round metallic strip feed system, but proved chronically unreliable and too delicate for battlefield conditions.



▲ BREN

Date 1938

Origin UK

Barrel 25in (63.5cm)

Caliber .303in

Developed at Brno in the Czech Republic and modified at Enfield, London (hence its name), the Bren gun was the British Army's principal light support weapon from its introduction until the 1970s, latterly in 7.62mm NATO chambering. If it had a deficiency, it lay in its ammunition having a protruding rim around the .303in cartridge base, a feature corrected in the 7.62mm NATO round.

FULL VIEW